seems as if none of them likes to break the silence. For the tenth time in ten minutes, Evie goes to the window and looks along the sultry road.

THE SCENE : At Baldwin's

MARTHA: It's time he was home.

EVIE: Yes, mother.

MARTHA: I do hope he hasn't forgotten his umbrella; he has such a habit of leaving it behind him.

EVIE: Yes, Mother.

MARTHA: It might rain. Don't you think so, Evie?

EVIE: (*after a pause*) Mother (*There is no answer.*)

Mother! [*Mrs. Baldwin turns slowly*] What does Mr. Gresham want with him? Has he done anything wrong?

MARTHA: (*proudly*) Your father? No, Evie.

EVIE: Then why did Mr. Gresham send for him?

Let's understand better:

Martha and Evie hear that Gresham had been arrested on suspicion of committing a fraud in his bank. They are angry and shocked at the news.



MARTHA: He wanted to talk to him.

EVIE: What about? Mr. Gresham has been arrested; they're going to try him tomorrow. What can he want with Father?

MARTHA: Your father will have to give evidence.

EVIE: But he's going to give evidence against Mr. Gresham. Why should Mr. Gresham want to see him?

MARTHA: I don't know, Evie, you know, your father doesn't say much about his business affairs. (*she pauses*) I didn't know there was anything wrong with the Bank until I saw it in the papers. Your father wouldn't tell me to draw my money out – he thought it wasn't loyal to Mr. Gresham. (*Evie nods*) I did it of my own accord-against his wishes–when I suspected…

EVIE: (*after a pause*) Do you think that Father had anything to do with – with… (she does not like to say it)

MARTHA: With the **wrecking** of the Bank? You know him better than that, Evie.

EVIE: But did he not know what was going on?

MARTHA: (*after a pause*) Evie, I don't believe your father ever did a wrong thing in his life – not if he knew it was wrong. He found out by accident – found out what Mr. Gresham was doing.

EVIE: How do you know that?

MARTHA: I don't know it. I suspect it – something he said. You see, Evie, he can't have done anything wrong. They haven't indicted him.

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